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DeepL · Team administration

Designing a custom-domain lifecycle an admin can safely manage

I wrote the request, validation, replacement, approval and removal states for a team-specific DeepL domain.

My role

Content designer for the customer-facing custom-domain lifecycle

Worked with

Enterprise product, product design, operations and engineering

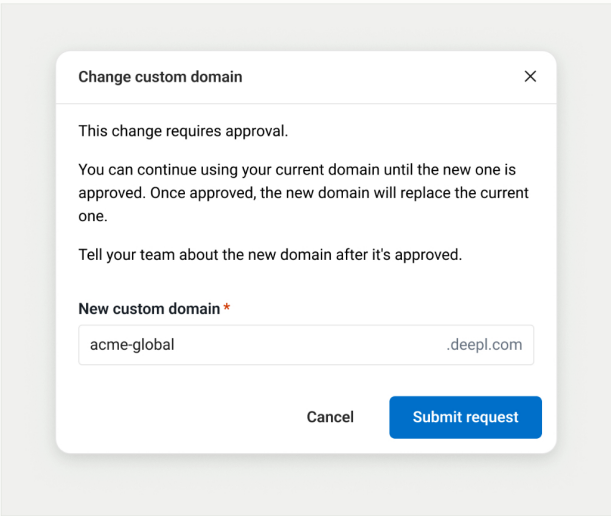
Why it mattered

A domain change affects how an entire team reaches DeepL, and some changes require approval before they can take effect.

01 · The experience

Keeping availability and approval status clear during a domain change

Change request



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The change state says that approval is required and that the current domain remains available until the replacement is approved.

02 · The problem

A domain change affects how an entire team reaches DeepL, and some changes require approval before they can take effect.

A custom domain looks like a short text field, but the administrative action has a longer lifecycle. The requested value must meet format rules, the request may wait for approval and a replacement can affect the route an entire team already uses.

The interface also needed to separate changing a domain from removing it. A change preserves access while review is pending; removal takes effect immediately and can disrupt every team member who relies on the old address.

Constraint

The interface had to distinguish a pending request from an active domain, keep the current route available during review and make immediate removal consequences unmistakable.

03 · The language turn

Turn one field into a visible lifecycle

BEFORE	AFTER
Save a custom URL	Request · validate · keep the current domain active · approve · notify · remove with an

Before approval, team removal has an explicit consequence

04 - The judgment

The decisions doing the work

- 01

Name the public object consistently

'Custom domain' matches the product and support language, while the fixed .deepl.com suffix shows exactly what the admin is choosing.
- 02

Put format rules beside the field

Letters, numbers, hyphens and underscores are explained before submission; the error then identifies spaces as the invalid input.
- 03

Explain the pending state

The change dialog states that the current domain remains usable until approval and tells the admin when to inform the team.
- 04

Treat removal as a different risk

The removal confirmation names the immediate loss of access and asks the admin to notify the team before committing.
- The trade-off:** The change dialog is longer than a typical settings form, but the extra copy explains timing and team impact that the field alone cannot communicate.

05 - The sequence

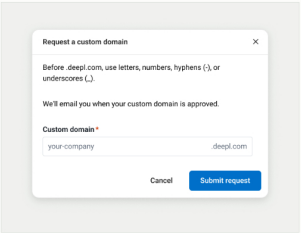
From an empty request to an active—or removed—team domain

01	02	03	04	05
Request Enter a team-specific value with the .deepl.com suffix visible.	Validate Identify unsupported spaces and keep the allowed characters close to the error.	Change safely Keep the current domain working while the replacement waits for approval.	Confirm activation Email the team when the first domain or its replacement becomes active.	Remove deliberately Warn that removal is immediate and can interrupt team access.

06 - The complete source

Every export from the custom-domain source flow

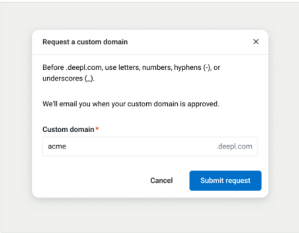
Custom-domain dialog - 01



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Complete exported dialog state from the custom-domain source flow.

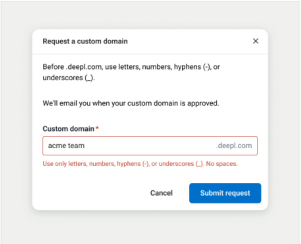
Custom-domain dialog - 02



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Complete exported dialog state from the custom-domain source flow.

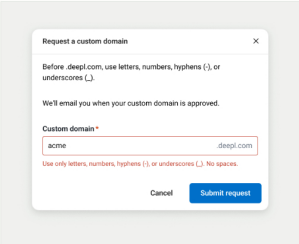
Custom-domain dialog - 03



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Complete exported dialog state from the custom-domain source flow.

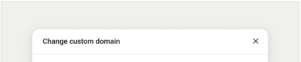
Custom-domain dialog - 04



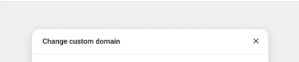
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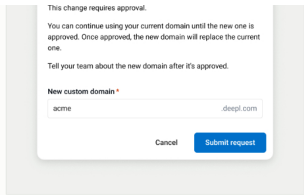
Complete exported dialog state from the custom-domain source flow.

Custom-domain dialog - 05



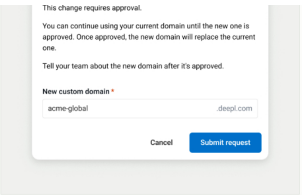
Custom-domain dialog - 06





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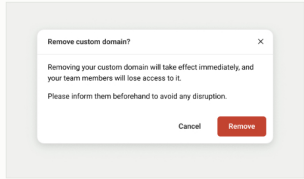
Complete exported dialog state from the custom-domain source flow.



[View larger](#)

Complete exported dialog state from the custom-domain source flow.

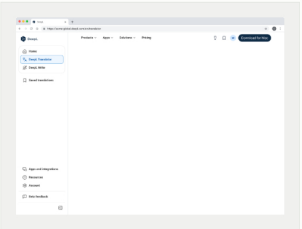
Custom-domain dialog - 07



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Complete exported dialog state from the custom-domain source flow.

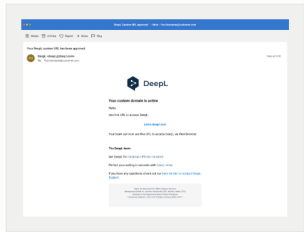
Customer domain state



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Complete exported customer-facing domain state.

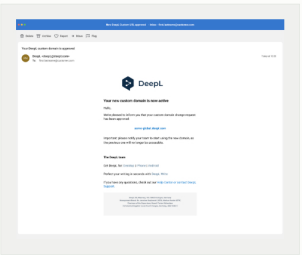
Approval email



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Complete exported first-domain approval email.

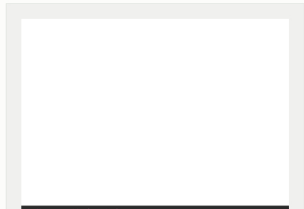
Replacement email



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Complete exported replacement-domain approval email.

Operations state - 01



Operations state - 02

